

SYDNEY B. GARCIA

sbgarcia@princeton.edu | sydneybgarcia.com

EMPLOYMENT AND EDUCATION

2022 - 2028 (expected) PhD Student in Psychology and Social Policy at Princeton University

2020 - 2022 Research Coordinator at Stanford University

2016 - 2020 BA in Psychology with Honors at the University of California, Berkeley

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Deviance | Social Norms | Social Norm Enforcement & Punishment | Gender | Media Effects | Field Experiments

PUBLICATIONS

Pei, R., Grayson, S., Appel, R., Soh, S., **Garcia, S. B.**, Bouwer, A. , Huang, E., Jackson, M., Harari, G. & Zaki, J. (in press). Bridging the Empathy Gap: Enhancing Empathy Perceptions Fosters Social Connection. *Nature Human Behaviour*.

Reddan, M., **Garcia, S. B.**, Golarai, G., Eberhardt, J., Zaki, J. (2024). Film intervention increases empathic understanding of formerly incarcerated people and support for criminal justice reform. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*.

Zieve, G. G., Armstrong, C. A., Richardson, I. M., **Garcia, S. B.**, & Harvey, A. G. (2022). Measuring memory for treatment using patient conceptualizations of clinical vignettes: A pilot psychometric study in the context of cognitive therapy for depression. *Cognitive Therapy and Research*.

Monroy, M., **Garcia, S. B.**, Mendoza-Denton, R., Keltner, D. (2021). The Dynamics of Coping, Positive Emotions, and Well-being: Evidence from Latinx Immigrant Farmworkers and College Students During a Time of Political Strife. *Emotion*.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

Garcia, S. B. (in prep; writing). Comparing Reactions to Prescriptive and Descriptive Norm Violations.

Garcia, S. B., Dannals, J., & Paluck, E. L. (in prep; data collection). Effects of Polarized Reactions to Norm Violations on Norm Perception.

Garcia, S. B., Khan, S. A., & Paluck, E. L. (in prep; writing). The emergence of deviance: experiments testing the personal effects of violating a social norm.

Reddan, M., Golarai, G., **Garcia, S. B.**, Eberhardt, J., & Zaki, J. (in prep; writing). Exploring the Persistence of the Effects of a Film Intervention on Empathic Understanding of Formerly Incarcerated People and Support for Criminal Justice Reform.

Reddan, M., Golarai, G., **Garcia, S. B.**, Eberhardt, J., & Zaki, J. (in prep; data collection). Neural Underpinnings of the Effects of a Film Intervention on Empathic Understanding of Formerly Incarcerated People and Support for Criminal Justice Reform.

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

Invited Talks

July 2024 "Best Practices for Handling Missing Data"
Socioecological Neuroscience Lab (SNL) at Albert Einstein College of Medicine

Conference Talks

February 2025 "Effects of a Film Intervention on Empathic Understanding of Formerly Incarcerated People and Support for Criminal Justice Reform" at SPSP 2025

August 2019 "La Vida es Buena: Joy, Well-being, and Familialism Among Latinx Farmworkers"
National McNair Conference at University of California, Los Angeles

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Garcia, S. B., Carey, R., Emery, L., (2024). "Oversharing or Bonding? Understanding the Limits of Self-Disclosure in Making Friends". Society for Personality and Social Psychology Close Relationships Preconference. San Diego, CA.

Grayson, S., Pei, R., Soh, S., Appel, R., **Garcia, S. B.**, Zaki, J., Harari, G., Jackson, M. (2023). "Norms and Nudges-Based Interventions to Increase Sociality in College Students". Society for Personality and Social Psychology Intervention Preconference. Atlanta, GA.

Grayson, S., Pei, R., Soh, S., Appel, R., **Garcia, S. B.**, Zaki, J., Harari, G., Jackson, M. (2023). "Empathy Perception Gap Poses Barrier for Social Connection and Well-Being". Society for Personality and Social Psychology. Atlanta, GA.

Garcia, S. B. (2021). "Does Anti-Immigrant Rhetoric Matter? Comparing the Daily Political Awareness and Well-Being of Mexican Farmworkers and College Students". Society for Personality and Social Psychology. Virtual Conference.

Garcia, S. B. (2020). “Not Just Words?: Relationship between News Consumption, Daily Emotions, and Stress for Latinx Farmworkers”. Society for Personality and Social Psychology. New Orleans, LA.

SERVICE

2024	Ad hoc reviewer, Political Psychology
2023 - 2024	Member, DEI Committee, Princeton Psych. Dept.
2023 - 2024	Organizer, Emerging Scholars of Psychological Science Talks, Princeton Psych. Dept.
2022 - 2024	Founder & Organizer, People of Color Affinity Group, Princeton Psych. Dept.
2023	Volunteer, Visiting Days for Prospective PhD Students, Princeton Psych. Dept.
2021 - 2022	Organizer, Black, Indigenous & POC Affinity Group, Stanford Psych. Dept.
2021	Mentor, Paths to PhD Program, Stanford Psych. Dept.
2020	Organizer, Professional Development Talk Series for URM, Stanford Psych. Dept.

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

2024, 2025	Cognitive Science Program Graduate Student Research Fund
2023 - 2026	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship
2022 - 2024	President’s Fellowship, Princeton University
2019 - 2020	Haas Scholars Program, University of California, Berkeley
2020	Warner Brown Memorial Prize, University of California, Berkeley
2020	Diversity Undergraduate Registration Award, SPSP
2019	Center for Race & Gender Research Grant, University of California, Berkeley
2019	Ronald E. McNair Scholars Program, University of California, Berkeley

SKILLS

Programming: Proficient in R, R Markdown, and LaTeX; Beginner in Python
Applications: Proficient in Overleaf, Qualtrics, and Affectiva

OTHER WRITING

Garcia, S. B. (2024). Brad Pitt can wear a skirt but my younger brother can’t. That needs to change. [*SF Chronicle*](#)

MEDIA COVERAGE

Keegan, R. (2024). Can Watching Movies Rewire Your Brain? [*The Hollywood Reporter*](#)
De Witte, M. (2024). The transformative power of film. [*The Stanford Report*](#)